

COMPREHENSIVE KNOWLEDGE BASE

Passport and Travel Document Services in Tanzania

Responsible Authority: Immigration Department, Ministry of Home Affairs

Primary Digital Portal: Tanzania e-Immigration Portal — services.immigration.go.tz

Reference Legal Framework: Tanzania Passports and Travel Documents Act, Cap. 42

1. General Overview

A Tanzanian passport is an official travel document issued to eligible persons for international travel and for establishing identity and nationality when travelling outside Tanzania. The Immigration Department of the Ministry of Home Affairs administers passport and travel-document services.

This knowledge base covers ordinary e-Passports, passports for minors, renewal and replacement, service or official passports, diplomatic passports, emergency travel documents, specialized travel documents, regional travel arrangements, application procedures, payment, document verification, biometric capture, collection, tracking, and common administrative problems.

Requirements, fees, processing times, document formats and digital services can change. Information in this document should therefore be treated as a reference knowledge base and current requirements should be confirmed through official Immigration Department channels before payment or travel.

2. Service Categories

2.1 First-Time Ordinary Passport Application

The standard application for an eligible Tanzanian citizen who does not currently hold an ordinary passport and needs one for personal, business, educational, tourism or other lawful international travel.

2.2 Passport Renewal or Replacement

Used when an existing passport has expired, has exhausted usable pages, or otherwise qualifies for renewal or replacement.

2.3 Lost or Stolen Passport Replacement

A special replacement process requiring additional loss reporting, identity verification and any prescribed penalties or fees.

2.4 Damaged Passport Replacement

Used when a passport is physically damaged, defaced or otherwise unsuitable for travel or identity verification.

2.5 Minor's Passport

Passport application for a person below 18 years, subject to the applicable consent, custody and identity requirements.

2.6 Service or Official Passport

Restricted travel document for eligible public officers or persons travelling on authorized government business.

2.7 Diplomatic Passport

Restricted to persons who qualify under the applicable legal and government framework and is not an ordinary public passport.

2.8 Emergency Travel Document

A temporary or limited-purpose travel document that may be issued to an eligible citizen in urgent circumstances when a normal passport is unavailable.

2.9 Refugee or Specialized Travel Documents

Travel documentation for persons who qualify under applicable refugee or international-protection arrangements.

2.10 EAC Regional Travel Arrangements

Regional travel permits or arrangements may facilitate travel within the East African Community where applicable. These should not be confused with an ordinary Tanzanian passport.

3. First-Time Ordinary Passport Requirements

- NIDA National Identification Card or accepted NIDA identification evidence/NIN documentation.
- Birth Certificate or other accepted citizenship/birth evidence.
- Supporting evidence of Tanzanian citizenship or parentage where required.
- Introduction, residence or occupation confirmation where required by the current procedure.
- Proof of occupation or activity, such as employment, business or student documentation where applicable.
- Original supporting documents for physical verification.
- Photograph or digital-image documentation meeting current Immigration specifications.

The exact list depends on the applicant's circumstances. Applicants should not assume that one document substitutes for another unless the current Immigration instructions say so.

4. Passport Requirements for Minors

- Child's birth certificate.
- Required consent from parent(s) or lawful guardian(s).
- Parents' or guardian's identification documents.
- Evidence of legal guardianship where applicable.
- Death certificate or other legal evidence where one parent is deceased, when applicable.
- Custody, adoption or other court documentation where relevant.

Separated parents, custody disputes, adoption cases and unavailable parents can require additional legal documentation. The chatbot should not guarantee that one parent's consent is sufficient in every case.

5. Renewal / Replacement for Expiry or Full Pages

- Current or previous passport for cancellation or verification where available.
- NIDA identification or NIN information.
- Passport bio-data information and other pages requested by the application.
- Proof of payment where applicable.
- Additional documentation if personal information has changed.

Applicants should declare changes in name, citizenship, date of birth or other identity information and provide the documents required to establish the change.

6. Lost or Stolen Passport

- Police loss report where required.
- Sworn affidavit or statutory declaration of loss where required.
- NIDA identification or other proof of identity.
- Written explanation of the circumstances of loss where required.
- Copy of the lost passport, especially the bio-data page, if available.
- Proof of payment and any applicable penalty.
- Any additional declaration or Immigration documentation required.

A reported lost passport should be treated as compromised. If it is later recovered, the holder should contact Immigration before attempting to use it.

7. Damaged Passport

- Original damaged passport for inspection and surrender where required.
- NIDA identification.
- Written explanation of the damage where requested.
- Proof of payment.
- Additional documentation if security features or identity information have been affected.

8. Emergency Travel Document

An Emergency Travel Document is intended for urgent and exceptional circumstances rather than routine passport renewal. The applicant may need to demonstrate Tanzanian citizenship and the urgency or purpose of travel.

- Proof of Tanzanian identity or citizenship.
- Copy of lost, expired or unavailable passport where available.
- Recent passport photographs if required.
- Evidence of urgent travel where required.
- For citizens abroad, contact with the nearest Tanzanian embassy or high commission may be necessary.

An emergency document may have limited validity, destination or journey conditions. The applicant must confirm its acceptance with relevant destination and transit authorities before travel.

9. Service / Official Passport

Service or official passports are associated with authorized government duties. Applications may require institutional authorization, an official assignment or travel letter, the applicant's identity documents and other government documentation. The sponsoring institution normally confirms eligibility and official purpose.

10. Diplomatic Passport

Diplomatic passports are issued only to persons who qualify under the applicable legal and governmental framework. Eligibility is determined by the responsible authorities. The chatbot must not imply that an ordinary applicant can obtain a diplomatic passport simply by paying a fee.

11. Citizenship and Passport Eligibility

Passport eligibility depends on the applicant satisfying the applicable nationality, identity and immigration requirements. Where citizenship is disputed, additional evidence may be requested before issuance.

The supplied reference contains a broad statement about dual citizenship. Because nationality law is legally sensitive and exceptions or reinstatement procedures can apply, the chatbot should not make a blanket determination about a person's citizenship. Disputed or complex citizenship cases should be referred to the responsible Immigration/citizenship authority.

12. End-to-End Application Workflow

1. Access the official e-Immigration portal or designated service channel.
2. Select the appropriate passport or travel-document service.
3. Complete the application accurately.
4. Upload or attach the required documents according to current portal specifications.
5. Generate the official government control number where payment is required.
6. Pay the applicable fee through an authorized payment channel.
7. Monitor the application for vetting results, queries or additional instructions.
8. Attend the designated Immigration office when physical verification and biometric capture are required.
9. Present original documents for comparison.
10. Complete biometric capture and face-to-face verification.
11. After approval, the passport enters production and dispatch.
12. Follow the official notification and collection procedure.

13. Online Application Filing

Applicants should enter personal information exactly and consistently with authoritative identity and civil-registration documents, unless the application specifically requests another format.

- Check names and spellings carefully.
- Check date and place of birth.
- Provide accurate parent information.
- Use a current phone number and email address.
- Keep the application reference number.
- Upload clear and complete documents.

- Do not alter documents or create false information to bypass inconsistencies.

14. Application Vetting

Immigration officers review submitted information and supporting evidence. Vetting may include identity verification, citizenship assessment, comparison against existing government records and security checks required by law or policy.

If information is inconsistent or additional evidence is needed, the application may be queried. Applicants should respond through the official channel and provide genuine supporting documents.

15. Physical Verification and Biometrics

Passport issuance normally requires personal attendance at a designated location for identity verification and biometric capture. Officers may conduct an interview and compare original documents with submitted information.

- Facial photograph capture.
- Fingerprint capture where applicable.
- Digital signature capture where applicable.
- Document comparison and verification.
- Identity and citizenship checks.

16. Passport Production and Collection

After successful vetting and biometric enrolment, the passport record proceeds to production. The applicant is notified according to the current communication procedure when the passport is ready or when further action is required.

- Bring required identification when collecting.
- Keep the application reference number.
- Follow the designated collection location and appointment instructions.
- Check all personal details immediately after receiving the passport.
- Report errors through the official correction process.

17. Reference Fees and Tariffs

The following figures are the amounts supplied in the source material. They are reference values only and should be checked against the current official Immigration tariff before payment.

Service	Reference Amount	Note
Ordinary e-Passport, 32 pages	TZS 150,000	Reference total supplied.
Ordinary e-Passport, 48 pages	TZS 200,000	Reference amount supplied.
Service / Official Passport	TZS 150,000	Reference amount; institutional sponsorship may apply.
Diplomatic Passport	No fee stated	Eligibility and authorization apply.
Emergency Travel Document	TZS 20,000	Reference amount; confirm current and overseas arrangements.

EAC Pass	TZS 10,000	Reference amount; verify current EAC rules.
Lost passport replacement	TZS 250,000 stated total	Source combines a TZS 100,000 penalty with TZS 150,000 issuance fee; verify current tariff.

18. Payment Mechanics

Where payment is required, applicants should generate the official government control number through the current e-Immigration service and pay only through supported official channels.

- M-Pesa.
- Tigo Pesa.
- Airtel Money.
- HaloPesa.
- Participating commercial banks such as CRDB, NMB and NBC, where currently supported.

Applicants should retain the control number, payment receipt and transaction reference. If payment is made but the application remains unpaid, use the official reconciliation or support process before making another payment.

19. Application Tracking

Applicants can monitor their application using the official tracking facility where available. The reference material identifies stages such as Application Received, Pending Vetting, Payment Clearance, Biometrics Captured, In Production and Ready for Pick-Up.

- Keep the application reference number.
- Use the registered phone number or other requested credentials.
- Check official notifications.
- Respond promptly to queries.
- Avoid unofficial tracking websites or agents.

20. Common Status Meanings

Application Received: The application has entered the system and is awaiting further processing.

Pending Vetting: The application is awaiting or undergoing identity, citizenship or document review.

Payment Clearance: Payment is being confirmed or is required before the application proceeds.

Biometrics Captured: The physical biometric stage has been completed.

In Production: The passport is undergoing production or personalization.

Ready for Pick-Up: The passport is available for collection according to official notification.

Query / Additional Information Required: The authority needs clarification or additional documentation.

21. Tanzanians Living Abroad

Citizens abroad may use the official e-Immigration system and/or the nearest Tanzanian embassy or high commission according to the services available in that location.

- Identify the nearest Tanzanian diplomatic mission.
- Confirm passport services available there.
- Prepare original citizenship and identity documents.
- Follow appointment and collection instructions.
- Confirm destination and transit-country requirements separately.

22. Urgent Medical or Official Travel

Where expedited processing is officially available, an applicant may request urgent handling and provide genuine evidence such as medical referral documentation or an official assignment letter. The chatbot must never guarantee a specific 24- or 48-hour issuance period.

23. Citizenship Disputes

If citizenship is questioned during vetting, the application may be held for further investigation. Evidence can include birth records, parents' citizenship documents and other nationality evidence. A chatbot should not decide a disputed citizenship case; the responsible authority must make the formal determination.

24. Name Changes

- Marriage certificate where applicable.
- Legal name-change documentation where applicable.
- Updated NIDA information where required.
- Other official evidence linking old and new identity records.

Applicants should ensure that the passport application and NIDA/civil-registration records can be reconciled. Major inconsistencies can cause queries or delays.

25. NIDA and Birth-Record Mismatch

If NIDA information differs from the birth or citizenship record, the passport application may be delayed or queried. The applicant should identify which underlying record is incorrect and use the appropriate correction process with the responsible authority before relying on inconsistent information.

Applicants should never alter, forge or manipulate documents to bypass a mismatch.

26. Photo and Biometric Problems

Passport photographs or biometric capture can fail because of poor lighting, unsuitable background, facial obstruction, incorrect dimensions, image quality, equipment problems or other technical reasons.

- Follow current official photograph specifications.
- Use clear lighting and an appropriate background.
- Follow current instructions regarding glasses and head coverings.

- Do not digitally manipulate facial features.
- If the portal issues a query, follow the official re-upload or correction process.

27. Recovered Lost Passport

If a passport previously reported as lost is recovered, the holder should contact Immigration before using it. A document reported lost may have been cancelled or flagged, so recovery does not automatically mean that it remains valid.

28. Common Administrative Bottlenecks

- Missing supporting documents.
- Names or dates that do not match.
- Unclear or damaged uploads.
- Biometric or photograph failure.
- Citizenship or identity questions.
- Duplicate-record concerns.
- Payment not associated with the application.
- Incorrect contact details.
- Delayed production or dispatch.
- Special cases requiring additional review.

29. Security and Privacy

Passport information is sensitive identity and travel information. Applicants should protect their passports, NIDA information, application credentials and supporting documents.

- Do not share passport scans publicly.
- Never share passwords, PINs or OTPs.
- Keep the passport secure.
- Report loss or theft promptly.
- Check passport details after collection.
- Use official government websites and offices.

30. Travel-Readiness Checklist

- Passport is valid for the planned trip.
- Passport has sufficient blank pages where required.
- Name and date of birth are correct.
- Destination accepts the passport and nationality.
- Visa or electronic travel authorization has been obtained where required.
- Transit requirements have been checked.
- Passport is physically undamaged.
- Other required travel documents are ready.

Possession of a passport does not guarantee entry into another country. Admission is determined by the destination and transit countries.

31. Chatbot Decision Flow

13. Identify the service: first passport, renewal, lost/stolen replacement, damaged replacement, minor's passport, official/service passport, diplomatic passport, emergency document or specialized travel document.
14. Determine whether the applicant is in Tanzania or abroad.
15. Determine whether the applicant already holds a passport.
16. Identify special circumstances such as minor status, loss, damage, name change, citizenship concern or urgent travel.
17. Provide only the requirements relevant to the identified service.
18. Explain application, payment, vetting, biometric and collection stages.
19. Present reference fees with a current-information warning.
20. Refer legal, citizenship and exceptional cases to the responsible Immigration authority.
21. Protect user privacy and avoid requesting unnecessary identity credentials.

32. Frequently Asked Questions

Where do I apply for a Tanzanian passport?

Use the official Tanzania e-Immigration service and follow the current instructions for the appropriate Immigration office or diplomatic mission.

What do I need for a first passport?

Common requirements include NIDA identification, birth/citizenship evidence and other supporting documents required by the current Immigration procedure.

What if I lost my passport?

Report the loss through the prescribed channels and follow the official replacement procedure.

Can a child get a passport?

Eligible minors can apply subject to applicable parental/guardian consent and supporting-document requirements.

Can I travel with an expired passport?

Do not assume an expired passport is valid for international travel. Renew it or obtain an appropriate emergency document if eligible.

What if my passport has no blank pages?

Follow the current renewal/replacement procedure for a passport with exhausted pages.

Can I use an ETD like a normal passport?

No. An ETD is generally temporary or limited-purpose. Confirm its validity and acceptance before travelling.

Does a passport guarantee entry to another country?

No. Entry depends on the destination country's immigration and visa rules.

33. Applicant Checklist

Before Applying

- Confirm the correct passport/travel-document category.

- Confirm current requirements and fees.
- Gather original supporting documents.
- Check names, dates and citizenship information.
- Prepare digital documents according to current portal specifications.
- Keep contact details current.

During Application

- Complete information accurately.
- Upload clear documents.
- Generate the official control number where required.
- Pay only through authorized channels.
- Save the application reference and receipt.
- Attend the required physical appointment.

After Application

- Monitor the official application status.
- Respond to queries.
- Attend collection as instructed.
- Verify passport details immediately.
- Report loss, theft or errors through official channels.

34. Data-Quality and Safety Rules for the AI Knowledge Base

- Treat fees and processing times as time-sensitive information.
- Do not guarantee expedited processing times.
- Do not invent USSD codes, office addresses, appointment availability or fees.
- Do not make legal determinations about citizenship or dual nationality.
- Do not claim a document is universally accepted without current confirmation.
- Distinguish ordinary, official, diplomatic, emergency and specialized travel documents.
- Do not request passwords, OTPs, PINs or unnecessary full identity-document details.
- Use official Immigration channels for final confirmation.
- For international travel, remind users to verify destination and transit-country requirements.

35. Core Information Summary

Category	Key Information
Responsible Authority	Immigration Department, Ministry of Home Affairs
Primary Portal	Tanzania e-Immigration Portal
Legal Framework	Tanzania Passports and Travel Documents Act, Cap. 42
Ordinary Passport	Standard travel document for eligible Tanzanian citizens
Minor Passport	Subject to child identity and parental/guardian requirements
Renewal	For expiry, exhausted pages or other eligible circumstances
Lost/Stolen	Prescribed loss reporting and replacement process
Damaged	Replacement with inspection/surrender where required

Service/Official	For eligible official government travel
Diplomatic	Restricted category subject to legal and official authorization
ETD	Temporary/limited travel document for eligible urgent circumstances
Specialized Documents	Eligibility depends on legal status and applicable rules
Payment	Official control number and supported payment channels
Tracking	Use official e-Immigration tracking facilities where available
Key Risks	Identity mismatch, citizenship questions, biometric/photo failure, payment delays and document loss